

selected on any major retail website like Amazon India and Flipkart to show users related products and the lowest price available elsewhere. The extension also has new features which shows a price chart for each product on Flipkart to help decide the best time to make purchases. Users can also track prices of any product on Amazon and Flipkart as well. The latest iteration even suggests and provides users with discount coupons automatically at the checkout stage, that will surely save them the most money.

The biggest feather in CompareHatke's cap is their automated booking feature for buying high demand products. The extension proved very successful in helping hundreds of customers buy the Xiaomi phone when it released on Flipkart. It



THE REALITY OF CASHBACK

There is something primally satisfying about paying for something and then getting a part of that money back in cash. People somehow don't see it in the same way as they would a discount sign or a reduced price tag. There is victory in "cash-back", even if there is no sense. But that in no way means that it isn't an essential aspect of online shopping where savings in any form are welcomed and even more so – demanded.

In Europe and other parts of the world cashback has a different meaning. For example, customers can benefit from cashback in many brick and mortar establishments when using their debit cards. In these cases cashback means that you can add an amount to be given to you from the shop register when making a purchase which is deducted from your account. It's a convenience option that saves you a trip to the ATM – nothing more.

automates the process of adding products to the customers shopping cart when the sale period begins.

Normally the high demand for the website clogs up the website and only a small fraction of customers are able to reach the shopping basket stage to quickly make a payment.

CompareHatke is able to automate the feature and save critical time by competing with the thousands of simultaneous analogue users. In time it's expected that CompareHatke will broaden the functionality of this feature and keep customers happy with the savings in time, effort, money and worry.

MakkiChoose

MakkiChoose is another extension service for browsers which provides a lot of the same features as CompareHatke. It also operates in a similar manner presenting users with real-time information of comparative prices across retail websites while viewing a specific product. Although it doesn't have nearly as many features as CompareHatke, such as automated booking, it's a worthy extension deserving of attention.

Given the nature of competition it's likely that between these two extensions new features and benefits will eventually emerge, allowing users a choice even in whose services to benefit from for their shopping discounts.

Promo Codes and Coupon Mania

Another proven method of finding lower prices is with the help of promo codes and coupon discounts. Many shopping aggregator websites provide coupons along with cashback and price comparison features but certain websites specialise in digging up active coupon codes. Websites like **CupoNation.com**, **CouponDunia.in** and **CouponMantra.com** track retailer websites and provide customers with a one-stop-shop for finding the right coupon for the right retailer for the right product. They also include information for cashback schemes and high discount sales taking place on different websites. The best way to use these websites is in conjunction with extensions like CompareHatke to see if you've gotten the best discount promo codes and coupons for your deals.



HELPING CONSUMERS

With multiple active e-commerce players, the marketplace is becoming more competitive in its offerings and aggressive in terms of pricing. The most advantageous feature for consumers is the ability to compare the product across various e-commerce platforms and easily narrow the list down to the best offering.

This only takes a few minutes, saving many hours of physical shopping. Though e-commerce sites have been in India for a long time, the Cash on Delivery (COD) option has been the game changer. Consumers are sure that they are receiving the product and they pay for it in the traditional way and even if they don't like it, they still have a return policy which is even more convenient. Yet another reason is the ease of shopping, where once an optional profile is created, based on consumer preferences, products are suggested and even options of single click purchase are available. Sitting at home, a consumer can purchase a product as soon as he decides and identifies a product or a service and the turnaround time is remarkably less – which further tilts a buyer's preference towards online shopping.

Cashback = Discount

In India cashback is a bit more literal – you are returned a part of the cash you paid as a marketing incentive to purchase certain products. Cashback websites are a form of affiliate marketing – where these websites offer "cash back" on purchases made on their platforms. They do this by splitting their earnings from e-retailers like Flipkart and Amazon, whom they have promoted to customers for a fee. The cashback is essentially them splitting a part of their fee with the customer. In this way cashback is used to incentivise